

The Council · AI GOVERNANCE

Decision-Ready Paper

Template and worked examples for governance forums

AIG-DEC-02 · v1.0 draft · Draft for Council review · OFFICIAL

Purpose and place in the suite

This artefact provides the decision-ready paper that the Terms of Reference (AIG-GOV-06) already require: “recommendations and decision-ready papers for the Board on High and Critical systems”, “circulated in advance” and covering “system details, assessments completed, a risk summary and the safeguards in place.” The duty existed in the suite; this supplies the template to discharge it.

Decision proposition — state AIR-ID and list every covered UC-ID. For each use provide its assessment references, AGPI priority/risk, proposed outcome, exact permitted/excluded scope, delegated authority, conditions and effective/review dates. One paper may bundle uses only with a separate outcome row per UC-ID; missing or conflicting evidence is unverified, not approved.

It is the forward-looking brief in the decision chain. It sits ahead of the Governance Decision Record (AIG-DEC-03), which records the reasoned decision afterwards, and the Gate Log (AIG-DEC-04), which logs the gate event. Its triage headline is populated from the AGPI Triage Tool (AIG-ASS-01). The paper asks; the Decision Record explains; the Gate Log tallies.

Scope. The ToR requires a formal decision-ready paper for High and Critical systems. Standard and Routine systems use the same template in its lighter form (see worked example 3), or a delegated light-touch sign-off, applied proportionately.

What this is

The decision paper is the single page a governance forum receives when a system reaches one of its gates. It is not the evidence pack. It is a decision-ready summary that carries only what that forum needs to answer its one question, with the full evidence retained behind it as the audit trail.

Why forums receive a paper, not a pack

Forums are decision-makers, not document readers. Handing a board the full set of assessments slows decisions and invites either rejection or disengagement. In this model the AI assurance function distils the evidence into a standard one-page paper per gate. The board reads one screen, answers one question within its own authority, and records the decision. The full pack sits behind the paper, available on request or challenge.

Proportionate by design

Effort scales to risk. Most systems land at Routine or Standard and take a light path with a short paper and a quick sign-off. The comprehensive route, with its fuller assessment, is reserved for the small number of systems that genuinely warrant it, for example those affecting vulnerable residents or informing statutory decisions. The routine example in this pack sits deliberately alongside the high-risk one to show the difference.

How each paper is produced

- Produced by: the AI assurance function, which also holds the record. Specialists supply the underlying evidence (the DPO the DPIA, security the checklist, the supplier the model card); assurance distils it.
- Built from: the triage output (priority, risk tier, triggers), the register entry, and only the artefacts that bear on this gate.
- Disciplined to one page: technical findings are translated into decision terms, a clear recommendation and conditions are proposed, and earlier decisions are carried forward so no forum re-derives settled ground.

Lean rule: the paper should not trigger a new evidence exercise. It summarises the evidence already held under the AIR-ID and points to the source artefacts only where the forum needs to inspect them.

- Circulated ahead of the meeting: the template is identical every time, so forums learn to read it in under a minute.

Decision paper vs gate log

These two sit at the same gate and are easily confused. The simplest way to hold them apart is by tense: the decision paper is written before the meeting and looks forward; the gate log is written after and looks back.

Decision paper	Gate log
What it is The brief the forum reads to decide.	The permanent record of what was decided.
When Before the meeting.	At or just after the meeting.
Contains Recommendation, open question, blank decision boxes.	Outcome, approver, date, conditions.
Answers “May this proceed?”	“This was approved, by whom, when.”
Written by AI assurance function.	AI assurance function (as scribe).
Owned by Assurance (the brief).	The named approver owns the decision; assurance owns the record.

Who fills out the gate log

The assurance function records it, not the forum members and not the service owner. The forum makes and owns the decision; assurance is the scribe who captures it, because assurance keeps the record across the whole lifecycle. Keeping the people who decide separate from the people who keep the books is what makes the record trustworthy and auditable. The named approver (chair or delegated authority) is the one whose name sits against the entry.

Plan vs log: the triage tool produces a gate plan (which gates a system must pass, looking forward). The gate log records the gates it actually passed. Plan is what is intended; log is what happened. They are kept separate on purpose.

The template

A blank paper. Every gate uses the same structure; only the content changes.

AI Governance · Forum Decision Paper

AIR-ID: AIR-____ System: _____	Forum: _____ Gate: ____ of route	Prepared by: AI Assurance function Date: _____
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Decision required

State the single question this forum is being asked, in its own authority.

Triage headline

AGPI Priority _ (____) Risk tier: ____

Escalation: list any triggers, or "none"

Assurance route: Proportionate / Enhanced / Comprehensive

Recommendation

The assurance function's proposed decision, so the forum reacts rather than starts from blank.

Bearing on your decision

- Only the facts that bear on this forum's question.
- Technical findings translated into decision terms.
- Cost, benefit or alignment as relevant to this gate.

Conditions proposed

Any conditions proposed for the forum to attach.

Full evidence

Full pack held by AI Assurance under the AIR-ID. Available on request.

Decision

☐ Approve ☐ Approve w/ conditions ☐ Reject ☐ Defer

Decided by: _____ Role: _____ Date: _____

Worked example 1 · high-risk system, Gate 1

A procured tool that flags tenants at risk of rent arrears so the income team can intervene early. Special-category data and vulnerable residents are in scope, so it takes the comprehensive route. At Gate 1 the strategic board judges only whether it is worth progressing.

AI Governance · Forum Decision Paper

AIR-ID: AIR-0207

System: Rent Arrears Early-Warning Tool

Forum: Strategic Prioritisation Board
Gate: 1 of route

Prepared by: AI Assurance function
Date: _____

Decision required

Approve this proposal to progress to design and assurance? (Strategic fit and value only, not security, legality or design.)

Triage headline

AGPI Priority 2 (High) Risk tier: High

Escalation: special-category data; vulnerable residents

Assurance route: Comprehensive

Recommendation

Approve to progress, subject to full assurance at later gates.

Bearing on your decision

- Purpose: flag tenants at risk of arrears for early support. Supports prevention and financial-inclusion aims.
- Expected benefit: earlier intervention, fewer evictions. Indicative cost £[] over [].
- Strategic alignment: strong.
- The High classification means full downstream assessment (DPIA, security, supplier due diligence) is required. That work is planned and is not for this forum to evaluate.

Conditions proposed

Return to this board if indicative costs move materially.

Full evidence

Intake form, AGPI worksheet, initial risk screen. Held under AIR-0207. Available on request.

Decision

☐ Approve ☐ Approve w/ conditions ☐ Reject ☐ Defer

Approved by: _____ Role: _____ Date: _____

Worked example 2 · same system, Gate 2

The same tool reaches the technical board. The paper opens by inheriting Gate 1's decision, so strategic fit is not reopened. This forum judges only the design.

AI Governance · Forum Decision Paper

AIR-ID: AIR-0207

System: Rent Arrears Early-Warning Tool

Forum: Technical Design Review
Gate: 2 of route

Prepared by: AI Assurance function
Date: _____

Carried forward

Gate 1 (Strategic): Approved to progress on 4 August 2026, cost condition noted. Settled, not for re-debate.

Decision required

Endorse the technical design as feasible, secure, supportable and aligned to our architecture and data standards?

Triage headline

AGPI Priority 2 (High) Risk tier: High
Escalation: special-category data; vulnerable residents
Assurance route: Comprehensive

Recommendation

Endorse, with one condition (below).

Bearing on your decision

- Data flows: reads housing and benefits records; special-category data in scope.
- Integrations: requires read access to the housing management system and the financial management system.
- Security review: complete; no critical findings.
- Model card: supplier-provided; known limits and error modes noted.

Conditions proposed

Access to be least-privilege and fully logged.

Full evidence

DPIA, Security Review Checklist, Model Card, data-flow diagram. Held under AIR-0207. Available on request.

Decision

☐ Endorse ☐ Endorse w/ conditions ☐ Reject ☐ Defer

Endorsed by: _____ Role: _____ Date: _____

Worked example 3 · routine system, light path

A low-risk internal tool. The same template, but far shorter, because a routine system generates little to decide. Placed here as the deliberate contrast: this is what most systems look like.

AI Governance · Forum Decision Paper

AIR-ID: AIR-0231
System: Internal Minute-Summariser

Forum: Light-touch sign-off
(delegated authority)
Gate: single

Prepared by: AI Assurance
function
Date: _____

Decision required
Confirm registration and proportionate controls for use?

Triage headline
AGPI Priority 4 (Routine) Risk tier: Low
Escalation: none
Assurance route: Proportionate

Recommendation
Register and approve under local management oversight.

Bearing on your decision

- Summarises non-sensitive internal notes only. No personal data.
- A person reviews every output before use.

Conditions proposed
Reassess before any change of scope or data.

Full evidence
Intake form and AGPI result. Held under AIR-0231.

Decision
☐ Approve ☐ Reject
Approved by: _____ Role: _____ Date: _____

Proposed context pointer — AIG-INV-05

When useful, the decision paper may include a dated AIG-INV-05 context pointer (version, AIR-ID, UC-ID/CAP-ID or relationship Edge ID) to explain the service outcome and system boundary. State whether links are proposed or verified and identify the source/as-at date. Do not count map edges as approved capability, permission or evidence of completed assessment. The paper remains a recommendation; the AIG-DEC-03/minutes record the decision, AIG-DEC-04 records the actual event/conditions, and AIG-INV-04 holds current state.

Proposed integration annex — AIG-INV-04 / AIG-DEC-03 / minutes / AIG-DEC-04 / AIG-OPS-02

Status and boundary. Proposed integration text for Council review only; it does not amend the original template, constitute an approval, or populate a live system record. The existing decision paper remains a pre-meeting recommendation. The native Governance Decision Record (AIG-DEC-03) records the reasoned decision, the native meeting minutes record the forum proceedings, and AIG-DEC-04 records the dated gate event and event-linked conditions. AIG-OPS-02 records post-deployment monitoring evidence.

Record linkage and provenance

Use the governance-issued AIR-ID as the system key. A paper should point to the applicable native AIG-INV-04 AI Register record and its Evidence index entry; cite the AIG-DEC-03 decision-record ID and native meeting/minute reference; and, after the forum has acted, link the AIG-DEC-04 Event ID and relevant condition reference. Monitoring claims must point to the AIG-OPS-02 monitoring record and sample method. Use AIG-INV-04 Evidence index as the native evidence index, not as a substitute for the referenced evidence or decision.

- For every material statement or evidence pointer, record the source artefact/record ID, source sheet and row (or document section), source version, evidence/decision date where applicable, and source as-of or snapshot date. Preserve a stable location/link where permitted.
- Identify evidence as current, superseded, under review, or unavailable only from the native record. Missing source row/version/as-of information stays visibly missing and is escalated for verification; it is not supplied by assumption.
- A blank numeric field is not zero; a missing threshold, risk score, sample, date or result is not evidence of no risk, no activity, compliance or approval. Distinguish zero observed, unknown/not supplied, and not applicable.
- Show status and provenance as at a stated snapshot date. Separate planned gates from completed events, and proposed conditions from conditions actually imposed in the AIG-DEC-04 event. Do not treat the paper or a proposed recommendation as a decision.

Reporting and audit sampling

For portfolio or committee reporting, identify the snapshot date and reporting period, define the population, exclusions, numerator and denominator, and disclose missing/unknown/not-applicable records separately. Reconcile the report to AIG-INV-04 Core and Assurance data, AIG-DEC-03 decisions and native minutes, AIG-DEC-04 planned gates versus dated events and condition status, and AIG-OPS-02 monitoring records. A summary value must be traceable to source record IDs and rows; plans do not count as completed decisions.

For assurance or internal audit, sample from the native records rather than relying solely on this paper or derived reports. Record the sampling frame and population size, selection method (including reproducible random method/seed or targeted rationale), source version/as-of date, and each AIR-ID and native record/row sampled. Trace decisions to AIG-DEC-03 and minutes, events and conditions to AIG-DEC-04, and live outcomes to AIG-OPS-02 and its documented sample population. Record exceptions as findings or gaps, never as zero. AIG-AIMS-07 governs audit planning, independence, evidence and follow-up.

Authoritative and suite references

- Council suite references (controlled records; draft status must be checked): AIG-INV-04 AI Register, including its native Evidence index; AIG-DEC-03 Governance Decision Record; AIG-GOV-06 Terms of Reference; AIG-AIMS-07 Internal Audit Programme and Procedure; AIG-DEC-04 AI Governance Gate Log; AIG-OPS-02 Post-Deployment Monitoring and Review Log; AIG-AIMS-13 Source Assurance and Traceability Register.
- ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Artificial intelligence management systems — clause 9.1 monitoring, measurement, analysis and evaluation; 9.2 internal audit; 7.5 documented information. Validate clause interpretation against the Council's licensed copy. Official standard record: <https://www.iso.org/standard/81230.html>
- Local Government Act 1972, including section 101 (delegation), as amended: <https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1972/70/contents>. Decision authority and delegations must be confirmed against the current Council Constitution and Scheme of Delegation by the appropriate Council officers.

- AIG-AIMS-13 is the Council's traceability ledger and points to authoritative sources; its status/currentness and each source row's verification date must be checked before use. This annex does not independently verify legal status or create Council authority.

Open items for adoption: Council owners to confirm the AIR-ID / Event ID / Condition reference conventions and the native minutes locator; approve a reporting snapshot and sampling protocol; identify authorised locations for evidence links; and confirm delegation and licensed-standard interpretation. No values, decision, approval or source verification are created by this annex.

Standards and legal applicability — proposed QA cross-reference

PROPOSED QA INDEX — NOT APPROVED LEGAL ADVICE OR EVIDENCE OF COMPLIANCE. The listed instruments may be relevant to this artefact, but applicability depends on the case, service and Council delegation. Legislation, official guidance, Council policy and voluntary standards are different authority classes. The full 51-entry requirement inventory, authoritative URLs, validation owners and current versions are in AIG-AIMS-05; source checks are in AIG-AIMS-13. Do not treat a template, plan or cross-reference as completed assessment, adopted policy, ISO conformity or legal sign-off.

Requirement / instrument	Why check it here	Source
REQ-013 — Local Government Act 1972 (including section 101) and The Council's constitution and scheme of delegation	For actual Council decision/approval, verify the current Constitution and delegation.	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1972/70/contents
REQ-040 — ISO/IEC 42001:2023 Artificial intelligence management system	Proposed management-system design mapping; licensed clause review and adoption needed.	https://www.iso.org/standard/42001